

need to download mails from the server as in the O2 or Treo. The mails are delivered to your handheld. As of now, the only device available and compliant with this service is the Blackberry 7730. Consider buying this one only if, like we said, your life revolves around e-mail.

The Nokia 9500 Communicator makes a great messaging device due to its full keyboard and easy-to-use applications. The PalmOne Treo 600 comes in at second place, offering the advantage of one-handed operation alongside its mini keyboard. The O2 XDA II mini and Nokia's 7710 are pretty much in the same league when it comes to messaging, with their stylus-driven interface.

Motorola's A768i does no better than a cell phone on the messaging front. All these devices support POP, and hence make it possible to receive your corporate e-mail via GPRS.

Contact Management And Scheduling

Both the Nokia devices, the O2 XDA II mini and the PalmOne Treo 600, offer easy contact management with multiple fields for numbers, addresses, e-mail IDs, etc. Notably, the Nokia 7710 automatically links a contact's birthday to your calendar. Synchronisation of contact information with MS Outlook works perfectly on these devices. The Motorola A768i and Blackberry 7730, though not in the league of the Nokias and the PalmOne, also have a decent contact manager.

Nearly all the devices have good scheduling features. The Nokia 9500 and 7710 made good use of their large screen by showing the current month on one

half of the screen and the event on the other half. The 9500 offers you a yearly view of meetings and anniversaries as well. The O2 XDA II mini has the familiar Outlook feel, and is simple to use.

Data Manipulation

When it comes to reading and editing documents, the O2 XDA II mini and the Nokia 9500 take the top spot. O2's OS comes bundled with Pocket Excel and Word, making it simple to work with documents and worksheets. The ClearVue application allows you to work with presentations and PDF documents. Nokia devices are bundled with their own versions of word processor and spreadsheet; the 9500 comes with a PowerPoint presenter too.

PalmOne's Treo 600 features 'Documents To Go', which provides support for MS Word and Excel. The Pícel browser on the Motorola A768i allows for viewing of common documents and browsing the Internet.

Web Browsing

Thanks to its excellent widescreen, Nokia's 7710 is the best device for surfing the Internet. The Web browser, however, lacks features, and sadly, Opera is not yet available for this model. The Communicator 9500 comes in second, followed by the O2 XDA II mini; the browser on these devices is decent and their screens are reasonably large. The browsing experience on the Treo 600 and Blackberry 7730 is limited largely due to their small display; ditto with the Motorola A768i.

Connectivity

Nokia's 9500 Communicator lives up to its moniker, sporting the maximum number of

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connectivity options. The 9500 supports Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, IR and a proprietary Pop port for a USB connection with a PC. All this makes the Communicator an ideal device on a business trip.

The O2 XDA II mini and the Motorola support Bluetooth and USB for connecting to a PC. The PalmOne Treo 600 and the Blackberry 7730 lack Bluetooth, and use USB for PC connectivity.

GPRS is available on all these devices, so connecting to the Internet via a GPRS-enabled SIM is simple. However, you might need to carry some of these devices to your service provider's outlet, as over-the-air activation is not yet supported.

When it comes to good, old-fashioned telephony, the Nokia 9500 offers the best interface, followed by the PalmOne Treo 600. The Blackberry 7730 with its keypad is also usable. For all the other devices, you need to use either the touch screen or a five-way d-pad to scroll through your contacts, and then dial.

Conclusion

In this section, we were looking for a compact PDA-phone ideally suited for the mobile professional. Two devices stood apart from the rest: the Nokia Communicator 9500 and the O2 XDA II mini. The highlights of the Communicator were Wi-Fi, the full QWERTY keyboard, and the intuitive applications. For a globe-trotter, these features are a boon, more so the wireless capa-



Motorola A768i



Nokia 9500 Communicator

Score Board (PDA-Phones)

Device	Screen Resolution	Memory (Int-Ext)	MP3/Radio	Camera (Res/Video capture)	Wi-Fi/Bluetooth	Practical Battery life (Approx)	Overall Score	Price (Rs)
Blackberry 7730	240x240	16 MB	No/No	No/No	No/No	4 days	58.92	30,995
Motorola A768i	240x320	58 MB	Yes/No	NA	No/Yes	3 days	53.25	19,020
Nokia 9500	640x200	75 MB+	Yes/No	VGA/Yes	Yes/Yes	3 days	77.39	41,359
Nokia 7710	640x320	85 MB+128MB	Yes/Yes	1 Megapixel/Yes	No/Yes	3 days	69.85	29,400
O2 XDA-II mini	240x320	64MB+256MB	Yes/No	1.3 Megapixel/Yes	No/Yes	3 days	76.56	34,888
Treo 600	160x160	32MB	Yes/No	VGA/Yes	No/No	3 days	61.23	26,500

For the complete scoreboard, log on to www.thinkdigit.com